

grin... was too much to contemplate(第三段)形成鲜明对比“早期摄影技术不成熟,需要人们长时间保持微笑 vs 后来摄影技术显著进步,相机可以轻松捕获自然微笑”,由此得出结论“90年代的维多利亚人不愿微笑并非技术原因,而是另有他因”。we must look elsewhere for an explanation引出下文更深层次的原因。

【深层解读】第三、四段以 During the 1840s and 1850s... by the 1880s... by the 1890s 勾勒时间线索,以 But 提示逻辑脉络,借助 exposure times were notoriously long→exposure times were much quicker→the exposure was almost instantaneous 聚焦摄像技术的巨大进步,再由 The thought of holding a fixed grin... was too much to contemplate→Spontaneous smiles were relatively easy to capture 呈现维多利亚早期和晚期截然不同的摄像体验,由此在维多利亚人拍照时不愿微笑的原因剖析上,实现了从摄影技术因素向思想观念因素的过渡(photography/the daguerreotype photographic method→hesitated)。

V ① One explanation might be the loss of **dignity**^① displayed through a cheesy grin. ② “Nature gave us lips to **conceal**^② our teeth,” ran one popular Victorian **maxim**^③, alluding to the fact that before the birth of **proper**^④ **dentistry**^⑤, mouths were often in a **shocking**^⑥ state of **hygiene**^⑦. ③ A **flashing**^⑧ set of healthy and clean, regular ‘**pearly**^⑨ whites’ was a rare sight in Victorian society, the **preserve**^⑩ of the super-rich (and even then, dental hygiene was not **guaranteed**^⑪).

一种解释是做作地露齿笑会显得有失尊严。一则维多利亚时代广为流传的箴言称“自然予我们嘴唇以掩藏牙齿”,这暗示严格意义上的牙科学诞生之前,口腔的卫生状况往往非常糟糕。在维多利亚时代的社会,一口闪闪发亮、清洁健康、整整齐齐的“珍珠般的皓齿”难得一见,那是超级富豪的专属(而即便那样,牙齿卫生也无法保证)。

· 词汇注释与难句分析 ·

- ① **dignity** ['dɪgnəti] *n.* 庄严;尊严
② **conceal** [kən'si:l] *v.* 隐藏,掩盖
③ **maxim** ['mæksɪm] *n.* 格言;箴言
④ **proper** ['prɒpə(r)] *a.* 严格意义上的,真正的
⑤ **dentistry** ['dentɪstri] *n.* 牙科学
⑥ **shocking** ['ʃɒkɪŋ] *a.* 非常糟糕的
⑦ **hygiene** ['haɪdʒi:n] *n.* 卫生

- ⑧ **flashing** ['flæʃɪŋ] *a.* 闪光的
⑨ **pearly** ['pɜ:li] *a.* 珍珠的;似珍珠的
⑩ **preserve** [prɪ'zɜ:v] *n.* (某人或群体活动等的)专门领域
⑪ **guarantee** [ˌɡærən'ti:] *v.* 确保;使必然发生
● **经典搭配**
① allude to 暗指,影射

· 语篇分析 ·

第五、六段追根溯源,深刻剖析维多利亚人拍照时不愿微笑的思想观念原因。

第五段分析原因一:维多利亚时代的人认为“露齿笑有失尊严”,因为当时人们的口腔卫生状况非常糟糕。关键词:①the loss of dignity displayed through a cheesy grin;②mouths were often in a shocking state of hygiene.

①句概述维多利亚时代的人不愿微笑的原因:认为露齿笑有失尊严。One explanation 体现本段与上文的逻辑衔接(解释原因),并暗示原因可能不止一个(下文可能继续探讨其他原因);through 搭建句内因果联系“做作地露齿而笑→有失尊严”,由“露齿笑后果严重”解开人们不愿微笑之谜,且 grin(露齿而笑)有别于前文 smile,暗示尊严的丧失与牙齿有关。

②句指出这种观念形成的时代原因:牙科学尚未诞生,人们的口腔卫生状况极差。句内先借 ran 的僻义“原话为”引出维多利亚时代的一则箴言(popular 强调该箴言广为流传,被奉为圭臬):Nature gave us... 将“以嘴唇掩藏牙齿”归于自然法则(to conceal our teeth 与 grin 形成强对比,明确露齿而笑有违天意);然后以状语 alluding to the fact 追溯该箴言产生的时代背景:before... 提示“牙科学尚未诞生,口腔知识极度匮乏”,频度词 often 修饰形容词 shocking 强调“人们的口腔卫生状况普遍极差”。

③句以“看似健康的牙齿少之又少”反衬时人牙齿卫生堪忧。句首 flashing、healthy、clean、regular、pearly whites 集中展现健康牙齿的外在状态,而后 a rare sight 及其同位语 the preserve of the super-rich (preserve 指“[某人或群体]独占的领域”)直指“健康牙齿为巨富专属,拥有者寥寥无几”,括号内再以 even then 实现递进,指出“(没有牙科学指导的情况下,)即使牙齿看似健康,也不一定卫生”。